

BB: As you said earlier, you spend your life traveling the world. You must be accustomed to traveling these days?

BT: Yes and I have several homes but I spend very little time in my own home. For the past 15 years I wouldn't have spent any more than two weeks a year in my own home. Those of us who travel the world as much as I do tend to think of home as being wherever we are. We think on a global scale.

But I can't complain. I fly every week to somewhere, it's how I get to work and how I get to wherever I need to be for whatever reason. Essentially my work takes me to many countries and many situations that are both friendly and sometimes not so.

BB: More and more companies these days are looking to be global companies. How beneficial is it that you yourself operate globally and understand the nature of true globalization?

BT: Well that's correct in as much as I operate in a number of different countries and have clients all around the world. But it's a privilege really to be able to work with boards, CEOs and Managing Directors that are keen to see growth for their company not just regionally but globally. To assist in formulating innovative strategies and to assist them in the execution of those strategies using my experience is very rewarding when you see it come to fruition.

BB: How else are you involved in organizations?

BT: I can honesty state that everything I do I love doing, from board advisory and development to teaching seminars to raising money for various charities – from poverty to women's causes and building classrooms in rural communities. In every project, program or initiative I have had the opportunity to learn valuable lessons about people, places and problems.



BB: Can you provide some insight into how you practically go about changing a company's direction or adjusting its culture?

BT: Traditionally speaking – and it's the same today – most companies go into what they call an annual planning or strategy session which culminates in beautiful documentation with a beautiful collection of charts and budgets. But the reality when you go into the research is that over 90% of companies fail to meet their objectives annually and predominantly that is due to over-estimation of the market, under-estimation or under-appreciation of the culture they operate in.

In some cases it's just a rehash of the budget and strategy documents of previous years with very minor consideration for inflation, and also the residency of corporate pride and management ego. This is why many fail.

本思齊: 正如你剛才所言, 你一輩子都穿梭於不同的國家。經常外出, 對你來說應該是司空見慣了吧?

Brian To 博士: 我以全球各地為家, 卻很少真正留在自己的家。最近15年間, 我每年留在自己家的時間少於兩個星期。我們這類經常出遊的人一般以身處的地方為家, 這可能是國際視野吧。

但這未嘗不是好事。我每個星期都會乘飛機到工作、會議或因其它原因而必須要到的地方去。由於工作需要, 我要前往很多國家; 情況大多是友好的, 但也有不盡人意之時。

本思齊: 愈來愈多企業希望成為全球企業。你在全球各地工作, 且了解全球化的真正意義。這對工作有何益處?

Brian To 博士: 是的, 我的足跡遍布多個國家, 客戶亦來自全球各地。有機會與有志在地區乃至全球擴展的企業首席執行官及執行董事共事, 絕對是榮幸。憑藉個人經驗協助他們制定創新策略、實行方案並取得成果, 讓我感到滿足。

本思齊: 除此以外, 你還會以何種方式參與組織運作?

Brian To 博士: 無論是參與董事局、主持教學研討會、為慈善組織籌款、扶貧、女性權益或在農村建設教室, 我確實喜歡自己的工作。每一個項目或計劃, 對我而言均是學習人們、地方及問題的寶貴機會。

本思齊: 可否與我們分享, 你是如何改變公司方針或企業文化的?

Brian To 博士: 傳統上——其實今天亦然——多數企業在年度規劃或策略會議上, 都會展出很多精美的文檔、圖表和預算案等。然而, 研究統計指出逾90%的企業均無法實現年度目標, 主要原因是他們高估了市場, 卻低估了文化及經營環境。

有些時候, 企業僅重新調整前幾年的預算和策略性文件而已。決策者當局者迷, 卻沒有考慮到通貨膨脹因素。這正是不少企業變革失敗的原因。